DRAFT

Evacuation Readiness Checklist

Prepare and practice before an emergency so everyone can leave promptly. Check what is ready; write in what still needs action.

EVS-001

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Life safety comes first. If danger is immediate or officials direct you to evacuate, leave now. Do not wait to finish this checklist, gather belongings, or complete home-departure tasks.

Household: _____ **Reviewed:** _____ **Next practice:** _____

PREPARE NOW—BEFORE AN EVACUATION

1. Official alerts and terms understood

- ☐ I receive local official alerts in ways I can notice, understand, and act on, including during sleep or a power outage.
- ☐ I recorded the official alert source(s): _____
- ☐ I know my evacuation zone or other local identifier: _____
- ☐ Everyone understands the exact local terms for prepare, leave, shelter, road closure, and re-entry. We know terms vary by jurisdiction and will follow the instructions in each alert.
- ☐ We will use official information rather than rumors and will not enter a closed area until authorities permit re-entry.

See **EVS-003** for evacuation timing, levels, and locally verified terminology.

2. Contacts, meeting places, and destinations selected

- ☐ Each person carries household and out-of-area contacts on paper and, when possible, on a charged device.
- ☐ We selected an accessible near-home meeting place and an outside-neighborhood meeting place.
- ☐ We selected a primary destination and at least one backup that can meet our household's lodging, health, accessibility, and animal needs.
- ☐ Our plan covers separation at work, school, care, or other regular locations; authorized pickup people are current.
- ☐ We shared the plan with our contacts and practiced it on: _____

Near-home meeting place: _____

Outside-neighborhood meeting place: _____

Primary destination: _____ Backup: _____

Evacuation Readiness Checklist — continued

PREPARE NOW—CONTINUED

3. Two routes and backup transportation planned

- ☐ We mapped two routes from home and routes from school, work, and care locations, while recognizing officials may change routes.
- ☐ Drivers keep vehicles safely maintained and, when practical, fueled or charged; keys are easy to reach.
- ☐ Everyone has a ride, safe seating or restraints, and space for essential mobility, medical, child, and animal equipment.
- ☐ If our usual vehicle, driver, road, or transit service is unavailable, we have a backup transportation plan.
- ☐ We know how to check official road, transit, and shelter information when leaving.

Primary route: _____ Alternate route: _____

Backup driver/service: _____ Phone or contact method: _____

See **EVS-004** for route planning and **EVS-005** for transportation planning.

4. Go-bags, medicines, documents, and equipment ready

- ☐ Portable go-bags are labeled, reachable, and sized so assigned people can move them safely.
- ☐ Essential medicines and health supplies are current; refill, storage, refrigeration, and power arrangements have been discussed with the prescriber or pharmacist.
- ☐ Protected paper or offline copies of identification, contacts, prescriptions, insurance, and essential records are ready.
- ☐ Phones, alert devices, communication aids, mobility equipment, chargers, batteries, and other necessary equipment are ready to take.
- ☐ Cash, keys, sturdy footwear, weather layers, water, and ready-to-eat food are positioned with the go-bags.
- ☐ Supplies are checked on this schedule: _____ and after every use.

See **EVS-002** for go-bags, documents, medicines, power, and necessary equipment; use **EVS-010** for a detailed accessible-equipment plan.

Evacuation Readiness Checklist — continued

PREPARE NOW—CONTINUED

5. Children, animals, access needs, and neighbors accounted for

- ☐ Children know the plan at an age-appropriate level; a responsible adult and backup are assigned to each child.
- ☐ Animals have identification, carriers or restraints, transport, essential supplies, and accepting destinations.
- ☐ Each person's mobility, communication, sensory, cognitive, medical, language, and personal-assistance needs have a primary and backup solution.
- ☐ Service animals remain with their handlers; their transport and supplies are included.
- ☐ We arranged help with neighbors or support networks without assuming emergency responders can provide individual transportation.
- ☐ No one will enter or remain in danger to check on another person or retrieve an animal.

Person/animal: _____ Need: _____ Primary helper: _____

Backup helper/contact: _____

See **EVS-006** for children and animals and **EVS-010** for access needs and support networks.

Evacuation Readiness Checklist — continued

ONLY WHEN LEAVING—AND ONLY IF TIME PERMITS

6. Safe home-departure tasks

Do these only if officials allow time, conditions are safe, and the task does not delay departure.

- ☐ Take the people, animals, go-bags, medicines, necessary equipment, phones, keys, and destination information already prepared.
- ☐ Wear protective clothing appropriate to current official guidance and conditions.
- ☐ Close doors and windows and adjust utilities only when specifically directed and only if you already know how to do so safely.
- ☐ Leave a household contact the planned destination and route without posting sensitive details publicly.
- ☐ Use the route and transportation officials direct; stay alert for changing instructions.

△ **CAUTION — PREVENT HARM**

Skip any unsafe task. Never search for belongings, take a hazardous route, or handle a suspected leak, fire, downed line, or damaged equipment. See **EVS-003** for leave-now actions.

7. FINAL “LEAVE NOW” CHECK

- ☐ **Danger is immediate or officials directed evacuation: leave now—do not delay for this checklist.**
- ☐ Account for people and animals without re-entering danger or waiting for someone who has another safe plan.
- ☐ Take only the essential items already within reach; do not add last-minute packing.
- ☐ Follow current official routes and instructions, even when they differ from the household plan.
- ☐ Go to the safest available destination and monitor official updates when safe to do so.

! **WARNING — URGENT ACTION**

Once you leave: do not return until authorities say it is safe. If the planned route or destination is unsafe, follow official directions and use the safest available alternative.

SOURCES

Sources: Ready.gov, “Evacuation,” “Make a Plan,” “Alerts and Warnings,” “Individuals with Disabilities,” and “Pets and Animals.” Accessed 2026-09-25.